Zheng Qinwen Makes History and Sings Karaoke After China Open Win

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Tennis star Zheng Qinwen made history in Beijing by becoming the first Chinese woman to win the China Open. She beat Mirra Andreeva in **straight sets**, which means she won the match without losing a set.

The 24-year-old fell to the court after winning **match point**. Then, after her victory speech, she surprised the cheering home crowd by singing karaoke.

"The feeling was incredible. To win here in Beijing in front of my home crowd is one of my dreams," Zheng said. "I've been through a very, very tough year."

Zheng had elbow surgery last year and has struggled with her form and fitness over the past 12 months. Before this win, she had gone two years without a title. This was her first **WTA 1000** title, one of the biggest kinds of tournaments in women's tennis, and the sixth title of her career.

Andreeva, who is 19, led early in both sets, but Zheng fought back each time. The second set was tied 4-4 before Zheng took control. The crowd was very excited and sometimes noisy between points. Zheng made a **double fault** near the end, but she stayed calm and finished the match with an **ace**, a serve her opponent could not touch.

"I felt like I just forgot how to compete after coming back from injury," Zheng told reporters. "Finally, after so many losses, I [found] my fire again."

It was her 14th career win over a player ranked in the top 10. Even after losing, Andreeva is expected to rise to number three in the world **rankings**. Zheng is set to jump 31 spots to number 23.

"I'm so hungry, honestly, for what's going to come next," Zheng said.

Word Treasure

straight sets -- Winning a tennis match without losing a single set.

match point -- The moment when a player needs just one more point to win the match.

double fault -- When a tennis player misses both serve tries and loses the point.

ace -- A serve so good the other player cannot even touch the ball.

WTA 1000 -- One of the biggest and most important kinds of tournaments in women's professional tennis.

rankings -- A list that orders players from best to lowest based on their results.

Background you need

The China Open is a major professional tennis tournament held each year in Beijing, China's capital.

Tennis matches are made of sets, and players usually need to win two sets to win a women's match.

Players earn ranking points by winning matches, and bigger tournaments give more points, so a title can move a player far up the world rankings.

Coming back from surgery is hard for athletes because they must rebuild strength, fitness and confidence before competing at the top level again.

Break it down

LEAD: Zheng Qinwen becomes the first Chinese woman to win the China Open
KEY EVENT: Straight-sets win over Mirra Andreeva in Beijing
+- WHO: Zheng, 24, and Andreeva, 19
+- CELEBRATION: Zheng sings karaoke for the home crowd
BACKSTORY: Elbow surgery last year and a two-year title drought
MATCH DETAILS: Andreeva led early in both sets; tied 4-4 in the second; Zheng won with an ace
EVIDENCE: First WTA 1000 title, sixth career title, 14th win over a top-10 player
WHAT'S NEXT: Zheng jumps to number 23; Andreeva expected to rise to number three

Why it matters

Zheng's comeback shows how athletes can recover from injury and a tough year, and her win is a milestone for Chinese tennis.

Test what you remember

1. What history did Zheng Qinwen make in Beijing?

- (A) She became the youngest player ever to win
- (B) She played two matches in one day
- (C) She won without serving an ace
- (D) She became the first Chinese woman to win the China Open

2. Who did Zheng beat in the final?

- (A) Diana Shnaider
- (B) Sonay Kartal
- (C) Katie Boulter
- (D) Mirra Andreeva

3. How did Zheng surprise the crowd after her victory speech?

- (A) She played another match
- (B) She gave away her racket
- (C) She danced
- (D) She sang karaoke

4. What surgery did Zheng have last year?

- (A) Knee surgery
- (B) Elbow surgery
- (C) Ankle surgery
- (D) Shoulder surgery

5. How did Zheng finish the match?

- (A) Her opponent retired
- (B) With a drop shot
- (C) With a double fault
- (D) With an ace

6. Where is Zheng expected to be in the world rankings after the win?

- (A) Number 1
- (B) Number 31
- (C) Number 23
- (D) Number 3

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: D 4: B 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Zheng Qinwen: Winning at home was one of her dreams, and after a very tough year and many losses she found her fire again.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):